

Yuanyuan Li

Postdoctoral Researcher in Operations Research and Operations Management

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 Yuanyuan517

Appointment

- **Postdoctoral Researcher**, HEC Montréal and GERAD, Montréal, Canada (September 2025–present). Advised by Jean-François Cordeau, Yossiri Adulyasak, and Emma Frejinger.

Education

PhD	ESSEC Business School , Operations Research and Operations Management	France
	• Advised by Claudia Archetti, Ivana Ljubić, and Felix Papier.	Aug 2020 – July 2025
MSc	Polytechnic University of Turin , Software Engineering	Italy 2017
BEng	Polytechnic University of Turin , Computer Engineering	Italy 2015

Publications and Preprints

- ***Sprint or Walk? Managing Start-up Growth Before Facility Investments***, with Riccardo Mogre and Felix Papier. Working paper. [SSRN](#)
- ***Element Selection and Routing for Experiential Service Design: Experience Formation and Stochastic Optimization***, with Qiuwei Guo, Yifu Li, and Lindong Liu. Working paper. [SSRN](#)
- ***Emerging Optimization Problems for Distribution in Same-day Delivery***, with Claudia Archetti and Ivana Ljubić. *Computers & Operations Research*, 182, 107105, 2025. [DOI](#)
- ***Reinforcement Learning Approaches for the Orienteering Problem with Stochastic and Dynamic Release Dates***, with Claudia Archetti and Ivana Ljubić. *Transportation Science*, 58(5), 1143–1165, 2024. [DOI](#)

Professional Experience

- **Researcher**, LINKS Foundation, Italy (March 2018–August 2020). Developed optimization and scheduling methods for manufacturing and contributed to project management for the EU Horizon 2020 LEXIS project.
- **Research Intern**, Fraunhofer Institute for Transportation and Infrastructure Systems IVI, Germany (April–October 2017). Conducted risk analysis and predictive modeling for the EU Horizon 2020 SYNCHRO-NET project.

Teaching Experience

- **Instructor — Mathematics I for Economics and Finance**, ESSEC Business School, France (2024). Undergraduate core course; taught two sections of 70 students each.
- **Instructor — Excel Skills (Spreadsheet Modeling)**, ESSEC Business School, Singapore (2023). Undergraduate elective course; taught two sections with 47 and 51 students.
- **Instructor — Business Simulation Game**, ESSEC Business School, Singapore (2023). Led an online business simulation for 34 undergraduate students focused on global business operations.
- **Teaching Assistant — Decision Analytics**, ESSEC Business School, France (2022). Led laboratory sessions and assessed student reports for a Master in Management elective course.
- **Teaching Assistant — Database Management Systems**, Polytechnic University of Turin, Italy (2016). Led laboratory sessions on data analysis using commercial and open-source software.

Selected Talks

- **Sprint or Walk? Managing Start-up Growth Before Facility Investments** — USTC (2025); INFORMS Annual Meeting (2024); POMS Annual Conference (2024); IESEG–ESSEC–University of Cologne Operations Research Camp (2024); ESSEC Student Research Seminar (2023).
- **Reinforcement Learning Approaches for the Orienteering Problem with Stochastic and Dynamic Release Dates** — POM China (2023); EURO (2022); ESSEC Student Research Seminar (2022).
- **Machine Learning Applications in Optimization: Job-Shop Scheduling in Industry 4.0** — ODS (2019); MIM (2019).

Reviewing Activities

Ad Hoc Reviewer: *Transportation Science Production and Operations Management European Journal of Operational Research Transportation Research Part C: Emerging Technologies Transportation Research Part E: Logistics and Transportation Review and Networks.*

Language Proficiency

Chinese: Native

English: Fluent

Italian: Basic

French: Basic